Chapter 5 Phrases and Vocabulary for the Writing Section with Reference to Skill and Purpose

The phrases and words in each category can frequently be interchanged. Look at the sample essays, and pay attention to the context in which the phrases and words are used. You will get a good idea of when and how to use them.

Writing 1 (W1) To State the Reasons

- **There are different reasons why**
- **There are several explanations for**
- **There are many positive/negative reasons for**
- **There are some/more/fewer benefits/disadvantages to**

Writing 2 (W2) To Give an Opinion

- **(Why) I believe**
- **I'd like to explain why**



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- **Personally**
- **I'd enjoy**
- **I would prefer**
- **I think**
- **In my opinion**
- **As far as I'm concerned**
- **It seems to me**
- **I suggest**

Writing 3 (W3) To Set Up a Condition

- **If**
- **Even if**
- **If I could**
- **Whether (or not)**
- **. . . may/might**
- **. . . can be**

Writing 4 (W4) To Further the Argument

- **First (of all) . . . Second . . . Third**
- **In addition**
- **There are three reasons why**
- **Similarly**
- **Furthermore**
- **Moreover**
- **Further**
- **As an example**



- **For instance**
- **What's more**
- **Not only . . . but also**
- **. . . including**
- **More than**
- **Also**
- **. . . coupled with**
- **Both . . . and**

Writing 5 (W5) To Summarize/Conclude

- **In conclusion**
- **Finally**
- **As a result (of)**
- **In summary**
- **Therefore**
- **To sum up**
- **In other words**
- **To summarize**
- **Then**
- **In brief**
- **On the whole**
- **To conclude**
- **As we have seen**
- **As has been said**

Writing 6 (W6) To Restate or Repeat an Argument

- **To put it differently**
- **To repeat**
- **Namely**
- **That is**
- **In other words**

Writing 7 (W7) To Show Cause/Reason and Effect/Result

- **Consequently**
- **Because (of)**
- **Due to**
- **Thanks to**
- **If this occurs, then**
- **To this end**
- **Since**
- **For this reason**
- **As a result**
- **Caused by**

Writing 8 (W8) To Show Time Relationships

- **Immediately**
- **Then**
- **Later**
- **Afterwards**
- **After**

- **Before**
- **While**
- **During**
- **As soon as**
- **As**
- **Sometimes**
- **Last**
- **Frequently**
- **When**
- **Once**
- **Often**
- **Oftentimes**

Writing 9 (W9) To Generalize

- **Overall**
- **For the most part**
- **In general**
- **Generally speaking**
- **By and large**

Writing 10 (W10) To Show Contrast/Make an Exception

- **Some may argue that**
- **Although**
- **Even though**
- **Whereas**



- **Instead**
- **In contrast**
- **On the one hand**
- **On the other hand**
- **However**
- **In spite of**
- **Despite**
- **Unlike**
- **On the contrary**
- **But**
- **Yet**
- **Rather than**
- **Either**
- **Or**
- **Nor**
- **Neither**
- **Either . . . or**
- **Neither . . . nor**
- **Nevertheless**
- **Nonetheless**
- **Sometimes**
- **Once in a while**
- **Occasionally**
- **Some…other(s)**
- **Other(s)**
- **Often**
- **None**

Writing 11 (W11) To Emphasize

- **Above all**
- **Obviously**
- **Clearly**
- **Evidently**
- **Actually**
- **In fact**
- **Certainly**
- **Definitely**
- **Extremely**
- **Indeed**
- **Absolutely**
- **Positively**
- **Surprisingly**
- **Unquestionably**
- **Without a doubt**
- **Objectively**
- **In fact**

Writing 12 (W12) To State Policy

- **The policy is (that)**

Writing 13 (W13) To Argue/Make a Suggestion

- **. . . seems to warrant**
- **. . . contend/s**



- **. . . argue/s**
- **. . . justify/ies**
- **This observation is supported by**
- **To plead**
- **. . . suggest/s**
- **The suggestion is valid**
- **. . . propose/s**
- **. . . claim/s**
- **. . . state/s**
- **. . . clearly proof enough**
- **If I had the choice**
- **. . . examine/s**
- **. . . assert/s**

Writing 14 (W14) To Show Disagreement

- **. . . object/s (to)**
- **. . . disagree/s with**
- **. . . contradict/s**
- **. . . doesn't/don't support**
- **. . . is/are invalid**
- **These arguments, one by one, can be challenged**
- **. . . is absurd/ridiculous/unfounded/illogical**
- **. . . not to be taken seriously**
- **. . . has/have no scientific basis**
- **. . . dispute/s**

Writing 15 (W15) To Choose One Option over Another

- **. . . might be the better option**
- **. . . make/s it a better policy**
- **It's beneficial/better/positive**
- **It's detrimental/worse/negative**
- **. . . is true/false**
- **The assertion that…**
- **. . . seem/s to offer strong arguments for/against**
- **. . . is/are better/worse than**

Writing 16 (W16) To Show Similarity

- **Just as**
- **As . . . as**
- **In the same way**
- **Similarly**
- **Likewise**
- **As in/as with/as was/etc.**

Writing 17 (W17) To Show Purpose

- **In order to**
- **For**
- **So that**
- **So as to**

Writing 18 (W18) To Show Evidence/Give an Example

- **As evidence of**
- **The legitimacy of**
- **Such as**
- **For example**
- **A few of these are**
- **In the case of**
- **In addition**
- **For one thing . . . for another**

Writing 19 (W19) To State the Problem

- **The problem is (how)**
- **The question is**
- **What is being asked/challenged**

Writing 20 (W20) To State the Options

- **One option is**
- **The other option is**